

Early-morning deep synthesis. Assembles the already-baked projection bundle with the league scouting boards — nothing is recomputed. Companion to the gameday one-pager; this is the scouting-and-reasoning layer.

Fair-value readout (audit, not a directional call)

- **Fair spread:** CHI by 2.1 (model home-margin +2.1).
- **Fair projected score:** PHO 81.9 — CHI 80.6.
- **Fair total:** 162.5.
- **Rest:** CHI 2d / PHO 2d — even rest.
- *These are the platform's own fair lines — an audit of the model, not a directional call. No market price is quoted or implied.*

PHO — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** no qualified rim protector projects onto the floor — CHI's at-rim scorers face a soft interior.

PHO — rotation reasoning

- **Out (2):** Monique Akoa Makani, Jovana Nogic — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Swing (GTD):** Sami Whitcomb (proj 15 min / 5.1 pts) — a late scratch re-shuffles the minute pool.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Alyssa Thomas (34), Kahleah Copper (32), DeWanna Bonner (29), Noemie Brochant (23), Natasha Mack (22).
- **Provisional basis (read with caution):** Marta Suarez [cold_start] — projected off a thin / prior-shrunk sample, not a settled rolling rate.

CHI — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** Kamilla Cardoso grades best among qualified defenders on the floor (SAE +1.60/100 on 61 rim shots faced). Also above-average at the rim: Natasha Cloud (+1.56), Rachel Banham (+1.39).
- **Efficiency watch:** DiJonai Carrington (-18.1 PAX/100 overall).

CHI — rotation reasoning

- **Out (3):** Rickea Jackson, Azura Stevens, Skylar Diggins — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Natasha Cloud (31), Kamilla Cardoso (26), Sydney Taylor (26), Courtney Vandersloot (20), Gabriela Jaquez (18).

Matchup implication

- **PHO at the rim:** must contend with Kamilla Cardoso (rim SAE +1.60/100, last season) anchoring CHI's interior.
- **CHI at the rim:** PHO projects no qualified rim protector on the floor — CHI's interior scorers face a soft rim (last-season grades).

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